in 1983, an incredible hoax. For me, he had reached it long before then, when he opened his *New York Times* book review of Arthur Hertzberg's 1968 *The Origins of Modern Anti-semitism*—which saw its roots in the ideas of the Enlightenment, mainly Voltaire's antisemitism—with the not-so-rhetorical question: what if the Jews were responsible for the hatred they provoke? Jews may have had their share of responsibility for many things, but to consider them responsible for the hostility they provoked was a little too much, twenty-five years after Hitler. I am delving into this, because it is not uncommon to hear opinions according to which the Jews are responsible for the violence they cause, particularly in Israel. I agree regarding the consequences of the occupation, but that is as far as we liberal Israelis are ready to go. Today Palestinian violence is aiming at the very existence of Israel, and that, of course, none of us can accept. And, beyond that, classical antisemitism is rearing its head: see Elon Musk and what he is spewing against Soros, and so on and so forth.

Actually, I started with this train of thought after speaking of the possibility of Israel launching an attack against Iran, as I remembered an old discussion, also bringing us back to the late 1960s or early 1970s, with a French author arguing that Israel needed war, as an unconscious way of keeping united against the centrifugal forces tending to rent its national fabric. It was a clever idea, but I would not countenance it nowadays.

Levin threatens not to convene the Judicial Selection Committee; the Orthodox demand an immediate vote on the law about the nonconscription of yeshiva students; the Americans have renewed negotiations with Iran for restoring the treaty limiting the ayatollahs' nuclear ambitions. The treaty considerably worries Israel, which does not believe in Iran's peaceful intentions. Moreover, the US is not pleased at all with the installation of a religious school in Homesh, notwithstanding the Israeli promise to keep the place empty. It seems that relations with the US are moving from bad to